

Workplace Readiness Skills — Teamwork

Standard 1.1.3 | Personal Qualities & People Skills

Name: _____ Period: _____ Date: _____

■ STANDARDS CONNECTION

Employers consistently rank teamwork in the top three skills they hire and promote for. No matter how technically skilled you are, your ability to collaborate, support others, and contribute to a shared goal determines how far you go in any career.

What Is Teamwork?

Teamwork is more than working alongside other people — it is actively contributing to the group's success, not just your own. It means offering help before being asked, communicating openly, respecting different working styles, and putting the team's goals ahead of personal recognition.

Dimension	What it looks like on the job
Collaboration	Actively working with others — sharing ideas, effort, and credit.
Reliability within a team	Following through so others are not left covering for you.
Stepping up	Helping a struggling teammate even when it is outside your assignment.
Constructive disagreement	Challenging an idea respectfully without attacking the person.
Shared accountability	Owning team failures — not just personal ones.

Part 1 — Sort & Defend

Read each behavior below. Write the letter in the correct column of the sorting table: **Strengthens the Team** or **Hurts the Team**. Then circle the **one behavior you find most debatable** and explain your reasoning below.

- A. Finishing your tasks early and immediately offering to help a teammate who is behind.
- B. Doing your individual work well but refusing to help others because "that's not my job."
- C. Pointing out a flaw in your team's plan before the presentation — even though it delays the timeline.
- D. Taking credit for a group idea in front of the supervisor without acknowledging the team.
- E. Telling the team leader privately when a teammate's poor work is putting the project at risk.
- F. Staying quiet in team meetings to avoid conflict even when you disagree with the direction.
- G. Covering for a teammate's absence by absorbing their tasks without telling anyone — every time.
- H. Asking for help from the team when you are stuck rather than letting a task fall behind.

STRENGTHENS THE TEAM	HURTS THE TEAM

The most debatable item and why:

Part 2 — Scenario Questions

Respond in **complete sentences**. Support your position with reasoning. Your opinion matters here — back it up.

SCENARIO 1

A team member consistently does excellent individual work but refuses to help others and leaves exactly at quitting time every day. When the team misses a deadline because two members were overwhelmed, she says: "I did my part. That's not my problem."

Is she right? What obligation does a strong individual performer have to the team? At what point does "doing your job" become a failure of teamwork? What would you say to her?

SCENARIO 2

Your team is one day from a major presentation. A teammate tells you privately that she has been covering for another team member for two weeks — doing his work on top of her own — because she did not want to "throw him under the bus." Now she is burnt out and quality is suffering.

Was covering for him the right call? At what point does loyalty to a teammate become harmful to the team? What should she have done, and what should happen now?

SCENARIO 3

During a team meeting, one quiet member has an idea that is not being heard because two louder members keep talking over everyone. The team ends up going in a direction you think is weaker.

What is your professional responsibility here? Is staying quiet and going along with the group ever the right teamwork choice? What does good teamwork require of every member — not just the leader?

SCENARIO 4

A student says: "I work better alone. Group projects always end up with one person doing all the work. I'd rather just do it myself and know it's done right."

Is this a valid professional perspective, or is it a problem? What does this attitude signal to an employer? Is there a difference between preferring independent work and being unable to collaborate? Defend your position.

■ PEER COMPARISON

Find a classmate and compare your answer to Scenario 2. Write **one thing that was different** about how you each responded — and explain which response you think is stronger and why.

■ RESEARCH EXTENSION (if time allows)

Search "what makes a good team member at work" or visit **mindtools.com** and find one teamwork behavior you had not thought of before. Write 3 sentences: what it is, why it matters, and whether you currently do it. **OR** — describe a real team experience where teamwork either succeeded or broke down. What made the difference, and what did you learn?

Exit Ticket — Standard 1.1.3: Teamwork

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REFLECT & RESPOND

Describe one specific teamwork behavior — not just "work well with others" — that you want to demonstrate in your career. Explain why that specific behavior matters in your program's industry, and describe a situation where failing to demonstrate it could cause a real problem. Write at least 3 complete sentences.

This standard is assessed on the Nevada WRS exam. Your honest, thoughtful reflection here helps you think like a professional — which is exactly what the exam tests.